Capstone Project Proposal Defense Presentation Guidelines

Presentation Flow

To ensure a smooth, professional, and well-structured proposal defense, all groups must strictly follow the sequence outlined below:

1. Opening Prayer

The session shall begin with a short prayer led by one of the group members. This opens the presentation with respect and focus.

2. Introduction of Researchers

Each group member must introduce themselves briefly. Include:
- Full Name
- Course
- Assigned role in the capstone project (e.g., team leader, systems analyst, lead developer, UI/UX designer, researcher, documenter, etc.)

Keep introductions brief, formal, and confident.

3. Presentation Proper

Time Limit: 10 minutes maximum
Present your capstone project proposal using a PowerPoint presentation based on the content outline provided below. Maintain clarity, time management, and organized flow. Assign each part to the most familiar group member.

4. Question and Answer (Q&A)

The panel will ask questions related to any part of the proposal. All members must be prepared to answer, especially those responsible for specific sections. The Q&A will assess:
- Understanding of project objectives and rationale
- Technical and research feasibility
- Knowledge of methodology and design
- Readiness for project development

5. Verdict and Recommendations

After the Q&A, the panel will deliberate and announce the verdict:

Approved

Approved with Revisions

Deferred for Major Revisions

Feedback and specific recommendations will be given to help improve the project.

Required PowerPoint Content

Your presentation must include the following:

1. Short Background of the Capstone Project Title
2. Objectives of the Problem
3. Conceptual Framework
4. Scope and Limitation
5. Beneficiaries
6. Research Design
7. Software Model (e.g., Waterfall, Agile)
8. Project Plan (Gantt Chart or Timeline)
9. Population and Locale
10. Research Instrument
11. Data Analysis Techniques

Presentation and Attire Reminders

Time Limit: 10 minutes for presentation only

Team Participation: All members must speak and be ready for Q&A Attire and Appearance: Business attire (formal) is required for all presenters Submission: Submit your final PowerPoint and related documents to Mr. Jim-mar Delos Reyes 2–3 days before the defense

PowerPoint Presentation Tips

Familiarize or memorize your part—do not read directly from the slides.

Use the PowerPoint as a visual guide, not a script.

Keep slides simple:

- Avoid full paragraphs
- Use short keywords, phrases, or bullets
- Aim for audience understanding, not just panel approval

Include relevant visuals or diagrams (e.g., framework models, timelines).

Practice as a group to improve flow and transitions.

Tips for Answering Panelists' Questions

Answering questions from the panel can be the most challenging part of your defense, but with preparation and confidence, you can handle it smoothly. Here are essential tips to help you respond effectively:

1. Listen Carefully

- Pay full attention to the entire question before responding.
- Do not interrupt the panelist.
- If the question is unclear, politely ask for clarification:
"I'm sorry, may I clarify the question?" or "Do you mean...?"

2. Think Before You Speak

- Take a brief pause to organize your thoughts.
- It's okay to take 3–5 seconds before answering to avoid rambling.
- Speak clearly and with purpose—avoid filler words like "uhm," "like," or "you know."

3. Be Honest

- If you're unsure of an answer, don't make things up.
- Say: "That's a good point, and we will take that into consideration in the next phase." - Or: "We will revisit that area during our development and testing stages."

4. Be Specific and Concise

- Address only what was asked—don't go off-topic.
- Support your answers with data or rationale from your proposal (e.g., objectives, framework, design model).

5. Use "We" Instead of "I"

- Capstone projects are group efforts.
- Use "we" to reflect teamwork:
"We chose this model because..."
"We gathered the data from..."

6. Stay Professional and Respectful

- Even if a question feels difficult or critical, stay calm and respectful.
- Avoid sounding defensive or sarcastic.
- Thank the panelist for the question if appropriate.

7. Know Your Proposal Well

- Be prepared to answer anything from:
- Objectives and rationale
- Methodology and data gathering
- System design or technical models
- Target users and beneficiaries
- Timeline and feasibility
- Review each section of your proposal thoroughly before the defense.

8. Assign Based on Expertise

- During preparation, decide who answers what based on your group

roles. - Don't interrupt or talk over each other. Support one another if needed.

9. Practice Mock Q&A

- Anticipate possible questions and rehearse answers as a group. - Ask your adviser or classmates to simulate a panel and ask random questions.

10. Maintain Eye Contact and Good Posture

- Look at the panelist who asked the question while answering. - Avoid looking down or reading from the slides or notes.

Capstone Project Manuscript Guidelines

All capstone project groups are required to submit a written manuscript along with their defense presentation. The manuscript should follow the required structure and formatting to ensure consistency, professionalism, and clarity.

Required Manuscript Components

1. Title Page
- Contains the title of the capstone project
- Names of researchers
- Course, department, and institution
- Date of submission

2. Chapter 1: Introduction
- Background of the Study
- Objectives of the Study (General and Specific)
- Scope and Limitations
- Significance of the Study
- Definition of Terms (if applicable)

3. Chapter 2: Review of Related Literature and Studies
- Relevant literature, studies, and previous systems related to the topic - Theoretical and conceptual frameworks (with proper citations)

4. Use Case Diagram
- Visual representation of the system's functionality
- Clearly shows the interaction between users (actors) and the system components - Accompanied by a brief explanation of each use case

5. References
- A list of all sources cited in the manuscript
- Use a consistent citation format (e.g., APA, MLA) as instructed by your adviser

Final Reminders

- Use formal, academic language throughout the manuscript.
- Proofread the manuscript for grammar, clarity, and formatting errors. - Submit the manuscript in both printed and digital formats as required. - Coordinate with your adviser for any additional formatting or content instructions.